

Digging a burrow

When it was time to leave the nest, the young *Oryctodromeus* may have found its own territory and moved into abandoned burrows, repairing them. Alternatively, it could have dug its own burrow from scratch.



Mating

Males may have perfected their burrows—no female would want to raise chicks in a shoddy home! A female chose a mate and moved in to lay her eggs. Together, they built a nest.

Oryctodromeus fossils have been found in the burrows where they lived and died.

Puffin Today, some relatives of dinosaurs—birds—still live in dens and burrows. Puffin burrows are very similar in shape to the burrows made by *Oryctodromeus*.



Gopher tortoise These tortoises help out other wildlife. They make enormous burrows that provide homes for many different kinds of animals, including snakes, lizards, and rodents.



Safe from fire A burrow is usually safe during a forest fire because it's underground. The burrow retains moisture and the temperature stays low, even during a blaze.

